

Background Guide

ALL INDIA POLITICAL PARTY MEET



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Letter from EB:

Dear Delegates, Greetings from the Executive Board.

It gives us immense pleasure to welcome you all to the All India Political Parties Meet (AIPPM). The agenda for this committee, “Deliberating upon the implementation of the Uniform Civil Code in India”, is a highly significant matter of debate, affecting not just contemporary Indian politics, but directly impacting modern Indian society and the citizens of this country.

The Uniform Civil Code raises relevant questions regarding constitutional values, equality, religious freedom, gender justice, minority rights, and the balance between individual liberty and social reform. As representatives of varying political ideologies, your role is not only to defend the perspective of your assigned portfolios but also to engage in debate and propose solutions.

The Executive Board expects delegates to go beyond party narratives and display a strong sense of understanding of the functioning of judicial scrutiny, constitutional mechanisms, legal scenarios, and the diverse cultural and religious laws. Diplomatic arguments, factual and respectful disagreement will lay the foundation for productive debate in committee.

We encourage all delegates to research their portfolios thoroughly, understand their party’s stance, and be prepared to engage with clashing opinions. Remember that the objective of this committee is not merely to win an argument, but to simulate the functioning of Indian parliamentary democracy and arrive at a balanced resolution.

We wish you the very best and look forward to witnessing insightful debates, innovative solutions, and impactful participation.

Regards,

The Executive Board

All India Political Parties Meet (AIPPM)

About the Committee

The All India Political Party Meet (AIPPM) is a platform where representatives of different political leaders and parties come together to discuss important issues affecting the country. Politicians debate about policies, laws, and decisions that shape how people are governed.

In AIPPM, every delegate represents a particular political leader, that is your ‘portfolio’. Thus this committee brings multiple viewpoints into one room, which makes the debate more realistic.

This year’s agenda focuses on the Uniform Civil Code. It discusses themes of secularism, diversity and equality, making for many contrasting viewpoints and interesting debate.

AIPPM encourages practical thinking, quick responses, and active participation. As long as you stay involved and think from your leader’s perspective, you will contribute meaningfully to the committee.

About the Agenda:

Agenda: Deliberation on the implementation of a Uniform Civil Code

This agenda concerns the debate on whether India should implement a Uniform Civil Code (UCC)—a single, common set of civil laws that would apply equally to all citizens, irrespective of their religion, caste, gender, or community.

A Uniform Civil Code would govern civil matters such as marriage, divorce, inheritance, succession, adoption, guardianship, and maintenance. It would not affect criminal law, as criminal laws are already uniform across India.

At present, India follows a system of personal laws, under which different religious communities are governed by their own legal traditions in matters of family and personal affairs. For example, Hindus, Muslims, Christians, Parsis, and others are subject to different laws regarding marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption.

For instance, under the current legal framework, a Hindu daughter generally has the same inheritance rights as her brother under Hindu law. Under traditional Muslim personal law, however, a daughter may receive a smaller share of inheritance than a son in comparable circumstances. Under a Uniform Civil Code, inheritance rules would be standardized so that individuals in similar situations are treated equally under the same law, regardless of their religion.

Supporters of the UCC argue that it would strengthen the constitutional principles of equality before the law (Article 14), non-discrimination (Article 15), and gender justice, while also promoting national integration by ensuring that all citizens are governed by the same civil laws. They also point to Article 44 of the Constitution, a Directive Principle of State Policy, which states that the State shall endeavor to secure a Uniform Civil Code for citizens throughout India.

Critics, however, contend that a Uniform Civil Code could interfere with the freedom of religion guaranteed under Articles 25 and 26 of the Constitution. They argue that personal laws are closely linked to the cultural and religious identity of different communities, and that imposing a common code without broad consultation could undermine India's pluralistic traditions. Some also believe that any reform should be gradual and should involve consensus among all stakeholders.

The central question before this house is therefore whether the implementation of a Uniform Civil Code would better advance the constitutional values of equality, justice, and national unity, or whether it would place an undue burden on religious freedom and cultural diversity.

Merits of Uniform Civil Code (UCC):

A UCC for India has many benefits. Some of these include:

- Equality before law: As all citizens follow the same law, they are equal before the law regardless of their religion.
- Gender Justice: UCC helps remove discriminatory rules in divorce, inheritance, etc.
- National integration:
 - What it means: National integration means bringing people across different religions, regions, castes, and communities under a shared national identity.
 - How UCC helps: As UCC treats citizens as Indians first, rather than Hindus, Muslims, etc it strengthens a shared national identity.
- Legal simplicity: UCC reduces confusion created by different systems of law for different communities. An example of a problem caused by the current system of different laws for different communities will be discussed in Article 8.
- Secular civil law:
 - What it means: Secular civil law means civil law that applies equally to people across religions.
 - How UCC helps: UCC helps by separating civil matters like marriage and divorce from religion.

Issues with Uniform Civil Code (UCC):

A UCC creates some challenges. Some of these include:

- Threat to religious freedom:
 - Some people believe a UCC may interfere with the right to practise religion by replacing separate personal laws with one common civil law.
- Loss of cultural diversity:
 - One common law may not respect the unique traditions followed by different communities.
- Risk of majoritarianism:
 - What it means: Majoritarianism is the idea that the views and customs of the majority become more important than those of minority groups.
 - How UCC may affect it: Some minorities fear that a Uniform Civil Code could be based mainly on the customs of the majority community, which in India is the Hindu community.
- Implementation difficulty:
 - It may be hard to implement a nation-wide UCC
- Not always truly uniform:
 - Some proposed Uniform Civil Codes still include exceptions, especially for scheduled tribes.

Parties and Their Stance on the Uniform Civil Code (UCC)

For the purpose of this committee, delegates may broadly be classified into two major political alliances: the **National Democratic Alliance (NDA)** and the **Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA)**. In addition, some delegates represent independent or regional parties and may adopt positions based on their party's ideology and political priorities.

National Democratic Alliance (NDA)

The **National Democratic Alliance (NDA)** is the ruling coalition at the national level, led by the **Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)** under Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**. The alliance has consistently advocated for the implementation of a **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)**, viewing it as a constitutional objective under **Article 44** of the Directive Principles of State Policy.

The NDA argues that a UCC would establish a common set of civil laws for all citizens regardless of religion, thereby promoting equality before the law, national integration, and gender justice. Some NDA-governed states, including **Uttarakhand**, have taken steps towards implementing a state-level UCC, while others have expressed support for similar initiatives.

Delegates representing NDA parties are expected to defend and justify the implementation of the UCC using constitutional, legal, and policy-based arguments.

Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA)

The **Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA)** is the principal opposition coalition comprising the **Indian National Congress (INC)** and several regional political parties. Senior leaders associated with the alliance include **Rahul Gandhi** and **Mallikarjun Kharge**.

Many parties within the INDIA alliance have expressed reservations regarding the current proposal for a Uniform Civil Code. They argue that India's social and cultural diversity requires careful consideration and that discriminatory provisions within different personal laws should be reformed individually rather than replaced by a single uniform code. This perspective aligns with the observations made by the **21st Law Commission of India (2018)**, which stated that a Uniform Civil Code was neither necessary nor desirable at that stage.

Delegates representing parties within the INDIA alliance are expected to present arguments opposing the immediate implementation of the UCC while advocating for gradual, inclusive, and community-specific legal reforms.

Neutral and Regional Parties

Delegates representing independent members or regional parties are not bound by either alliance's position. They are encouraged to formulate their stance based on their party's official ideology, regional interests, political priorities, and contemporary policy positions. Such delegates may choose to support, oppose, or propose amendments to the Uniform Civil Code during committee proceedings.

Article 44 vs Article 25

Article 44 of the Constitution of India is a Directive Principle of State Policy (DPSP). Unlike Fundamental Rights, it is not legally enforceable in a court of law. It states that *"The State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a Uniform Civil Code throughout the territory of India."* The phrase "shall endeavour" means that the Constitution expects the government to make sincere efforts towards implementing a Uniform Civil Code (UCC), but it does not make it an immediate legal obligation. Instead, Article 44 serves as a constitutional goal aimed at promoting equality, national integration, and a common civil framework for all citizens in matters such as marriage, divorce, inheritance, adoption, and succession.

On the other hand, Article 25 is a Fundamental Right, meaning it is directly enforceable by the courts. It guarantees every person the freedom of conscience and the right to freely profess, practise, and propagate religion, subject to public order, morality, health, and the other Fundamental Rights. If this right is violated, an individual can approach the judiciary for protection. Article 25 reflects India's commitment to religious freedom and allows people of all faiths to follow and express their religious beliefs.

The debate over the Uniform Civil Code arises because these two Articles are often seen as being in conflict. While Article 25 protects religious freedom, Article 44 encourages the State to create one common set of civil laws for all citizens, regardless of religion. Since personal laws governing marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption differ across religious communities, introducing a UCC could replace these religion-based laws with a uniform legal framework. Some communities believe that such personal laws are closely linked to their religious identity and traditions, and therefore fear that a UCC could interfere with their constitutional right to practise religion.

Supporters of the UCC, however, argue that personal laws deal with civil matters rather than religious worship or beliefs. They believe that a Uniform Civil Code would promote equality before the law, gender justice, and national unity while still allowing every citizen the freedom to practise their religion. According to this view, Article 25 protects religious faith and essential religious practices, but it does not necessarily prevent the State from reforming civil laws in the interest of social justice and equality.

Thus, the relationship between Article 44 and Article 25 lies at the heart of the Uniform Civil Code debate. The challenge is to strike a balance between two important constitutional values—protecting religious freedom while ensuring equality and a uniform system of civil laws for all citizens. The question is not whether one Article should override the other, but how both can be harmoniously interpreted to uphold the spirit of the Constitution.

Different Personal law systems across religions

India currently has different laws for different religious communities.

Hindus, Buddhists, Jains and Sikhs are governed by a common set of codified laws, while Muslims follow personal laws based largely on the Shariat (Islamic Law). Christians and Parsis also have their own codified personal laws.

Scheduled Tribes are often governed by their traditional customs and, in many cases, are exempt from proposals for a Uniform Civil Code (UCC).

Most religious law systems require monogamous marriage with the exception of Muslims and certain tribes. Adoption also differs. Hindus, Buddhists, Jains and Sikhs can adopt under the Hindu Adoption and Maintenance Act, while people from other communities can adopt through the Juvenile Justice Act. Inheritance, divorce and maintenance also differ.

One of the biggest debates concerns issues such as polygamy, inheritance and divorce under different personal laws. Some people believe these differences are protected by religious freedom, while others believe they are discriminatory and should be reformed.

Judicial intervention regarding UCC:

Judicial intervention plays a key role in the extensive debate concerning the Uniform Civil Code. Below are a few cases highlighting the need to work towards an ideal resolution which is limited under constitutional mechanisms and is subject to judicial scrutiny. Remember, these cases form the basis of your research and are not the sole source of gathering information.

1. Mohd. Ahmed Khan v. Shah Bano Begum (1985)

This was the first major case to bring the issue of the UCC into national focus. Shah Bano, a divorced Muslim woman, sought maintenance from her husband under Section 125 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) after he refused to support her beyond the *iddat* period.

The Supreme Court ruled that Section 125 CrPC is a secular law applicable to all citizens, regardless of religion, and held that Shah Bano was entitled to maintenance. The Court also observed that a Uniform Civil Code would help promote national integration and reduce conflicts arising from different personal laws. The judgment led to widespread public debate and the enactment of the Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Divorce) Act, 1986.

2. Sarla Mudgal v. Union of India (1995)

This case involved Hindu men who converted to Islam solely to marry again without legally divorcing their first wives. The Supreme Court held that conversion to another religion does not automatically dissolve an existing marriage, and such second marriages would amount to bigamy.

The Court stated that the absence of a Uniform Civil Code allowed people to misuse differences between personal laws. It urged the government to make greater efforts towards implementing Article 44 to ensure equality and prevent such legal loopholes.

3. John Vallamattom v. Union of India (2003)

In this case, the Supreme Court struck down Section 118 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925, which imposed restrictions on Christians wishing to donate property for religious or charitable purposes through a will. The Court held that the provision violated Article 14 (Right to Equality).

While delivering the judgment, the Court remarked that although more than fifty years had passed since the Constitution came into force, Article 44 had not been effectively implemented, and a Uniform Civil Code could help remove such inequalities.

Law commission of India and their view on the UCC:

21st Law Commission of India (2018)

In its consultation paper titled "Reform of Family Law", the 21st Law Commission concluded that a Uniform Civil Code was "neither necessary nor desirable at this stage." Instead of recommending a single civil code, the Commission suggested that discriminatory provisions within individual personal laws should be reformed to ensure equality and gender justice. It argued that the objective should be to achieve equality within communities rather than between communities. This report became an important reference in the national debate.

22nd Law Commission (2023)

In June 2023, the 22nd Law Commission of India reopened the discussion by issuing a public notice inviting suggestions and views from citizens, religious organizations, legal experts, and stakeholders on the implementation of a Uniform Civil Code. Thousands of representations were received, demonstrating the widespread public interest in the issue. The Commission's consultation revived national debate, although it has not yet submitted a final report.

Essential Religious Practices (ERP):

One of the most important constitutional concepts in the debate surrounding the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) is the Essential Religious Practices (ERP) Doctrine. Developed by the Supreme Court of India, this doctrine helps determine which religious practices are protected under Article 25 of the Constitution and which may be regulated or reformed by the State.

Article 25 guarantees every person the freedom of conscience and the right to freely profess, practise, and propagate religion. However, this right is not absolute. Article 25 itself makes religious freedom subject to public order, morality, health, and other Fundamental Rights. Moreover, Article 25(2) specifically allows the State to enact laws for social welfare and reform, even if those laws affect certain religious practices.

To decide whether a practice is protected under Article 25, the Supreme Court developed the Essential Religious Practices Doctrine in the landmark case of *The Commissioner, Hindu Religious Endowments, Madras v. Sri Lakshmindra Thirtha Swamiar of Shirur Mutt* (1954), commonly known as the Shirur Mutt Case. The Court held that only those practices that are essential and integral to a religion receive constitutional protection. Practices that are merely secular, optional, historical, or administrative can be regulated by the State.

State UCC - Goa UCC:

This article, along with Articles 10 and 11, discusses the Uniform Civil Codes that have already been implemented or proposed in different Indian states. These state laws provide examples of how a Uniform Civil Code can work in practice.

Goa follows the Goa Civil Code. However, it is not a modern UCC law passed after Independence. Instead, it is based on the Portuguese Civil Code introduced during Portuguese rule.

The Goa Civil Code covers matters such as:

- Marriage registration,
- Matrimonial property,
- Divorce and separation,
- Succession and inheritance,
- Property sharing between spouses.

Although the Goa Civil Code is largely uniform, it also contains certain exceptions, particularly for Catholic and non-Catholic marriages, etc. Unlike the Uttarakhand UCC, which is discussed in Article 10, these exceptions are not based on Scheduled Tribe status.

Goa's legal system is often studied as an example of how a Uniform Civil Code can operate in India.

State UCC - Uttarakhand UCC:

Uttarakhand is the first Indian state after Independence to enact and implement a Uniform Civil Code.

The Uttarakhand UCC covers matters such as:

- Marriage
- Divorce
- Inheritance
- Maintenance
- Live-in relationships

The Act exempts Scheduled Tribes.

One of the most debated parts of the Act concerns the registration of live-in relationships, which will be discussed further in Article 12.

Critics have argued that the Act is majoritarian because it replaces certain practices under Muslim personal law with a common set of civil laws. Some have also raised concerns about the strict registration requirements and penalties under the Act and the increasing use of digital registration systems.

Supporters, however, argue that the Act promotes gender justice by providing equal inheritance rights for men and women and replacing rules that supporters consider unequal, such as certain divorce laws. They also argue that it creates a clearer legal framework for matters such as marriage and live-in relationships.

State UCC - Assam, Gujarat and Lessons for India:

After Goa and Uttarakhand, several other Indian states have also shown interest in introducing a Uniform Civil Code. For example, Assam has announced that it plans to bring in reforms related to marriage, divorce and inheritance, while Gujarat has formed a committee to study the possibility of introducing a state-level UCC.

An interesting observation is that all the states that have implemented or are currently working towards implementing a UCC after Independence are ruled by BJP.

State-level UCCs give us an opportunity to study how such laws work before introducing a UCC across the whole country.

Some possible lessons from these state-level UCCs include:

- A UCC should promote gender justice and equality.
- A UCC should avoid unnecessary interference in people's personal lives, as some critics argue happened with mandatory registration of live-in relationships.
- Heavy reliance on digital systems for UCC based registration might marginalize rural populations

Live in relationships:

Unlike the Goa Civil Code, the UCCs proposed or implemented in Uttarakhand, Assam and Gujarat include provisions relating to live-in relationships. Including this was considered both controversial and revolutionary in UCC.

Why it was done:

- To provide a legal framework for live-in relationships.
- To provide legal and financial protection for women left deserted by their live-in partner.
- To protect children born from live-in relationships by giving them clearer legal rights, including rights relating to inheritance.

Concerns raised by critics:

- Couples may fear family/social backlash.
- It may end up involving the state in private relationships.
- Ordinary couples could face legal consequences for failing to comply with registration requirements.
- Personal information collected during registration could be misused
- If parents are informed in some cases, it may endanger couples.

Tribal exemptions:

One of the unique features of the Uttarakhand UCC, as well as the proposed UCCs in Gujarat and Assam, is that they do not apply to Scheduled Tribes.

Supporters of the exemption argue that a Uniform Civil Code should not remove long-standing tribal traditions, as they are an important part of the tribes' cultural identity. They believe that protecting these customs respects India's cultural diversity and the special safeguards provided to Scheduled Tribes under the Constitution.

Critics, however, argue that exempting an entire group weakens the idea of a uniform civil code. They believe that if one section of society follows different personal laws, the law cannot truly be considered uniform.

Critics also argue that such exemptions may be unfair to other minority communities that are not exempt.

This raises an important question: should a Uniform Civil Code prioritise complete uniformity, or should it make exceptions to protect unique communities?

UCC in other countries:

UCC systems around the world can broadly be divided into four categories:

- **Developed Secular Nations**

Examples: France, Japan

Lessons for India:

- These models cannot be copied exactly because these countries are generally less socially and culturally diverse than India.
- Even long-established civil codes need to be reformed and updated over time.

- **Emerging and religiously diverse nations with a secular UCC** Examples: Brazil, Turkey

Lessons for India:

- A Uniform Civil Code can be introduced in emerging and religiously diverse countries.
- However, introducing such reforms may lead to backlash

- **Countries with UCCs Based on Religious Laws**

Examples: Saudi Arabia, Iran

Lessons for India:

- A Uniform Civil Code may risk becoming an embodiment of the majority religion.

- **Notable Exceptions (No National UCC)**

Example: Israel

Lessons for India:

- Delaying a Uniform Civil Code may create legal complications, particularly for interfaith, mixed-faith and non-religious couples.

Implementation challenges:

Implementing a Uniform Civil Code involves several practical challenges:

- Drafting one common code: Creating a single law that fairly covers all family-related matters.
- Religious and cultural concerns: Balancing equal civil laws with the protection of religious customs and traditions.
- Public awareness: Making sure people understand the new rules, registration process and legal requirements.
- Scheduled Tribe exemptions: Balancing the protection of tribal customs with the goal of a truly uniform law.
- National consistency: Preventing different states from creating very different versions of a "Uniform" Civil Code.
- Privacy: Protecting personal information while enforcing registration requirements.

Time Yields:

When you have time left after your speech, you can yield(give) the time in four ways:

Yield to chair: The time is returned to the chair, the next speaker is called **Yield to comments:** Delegates may offer brief comments on the speech **Yield to another delegate:** You can give your time to another delegate to speak, if they give their consent

Yield to questions/POIs: You can give time to other delegates to ask you questions based on your speech

Points:

Point of information (POI): One of the most common and important points in any MUN committee. This is to ask a question related to the delegate's speech.

Point of order (POO): This is to correct a mistake in a delegate's speech. There are two types.

- Logical fallacy: When a delegate says something that doesn't make logical sense.
Ex: UCC cannot be implemented in India because India is diverse.
- Factual inaccuracy: When the facts in the statement itself are wrong. Ex: UCC has not been implemented in any Indian state

Point of personal privilege: This is informal and is used to ask the chair for your own needs, such as going to the washroom, turning off the fan, etc.

Point of parliamentary inquiry: This is to ask the chair for any procedural queries, essentially questions regarding the rules of procedure

Note: Although POIs and POOs will be marked, Points of personal Privilege and Parliamentary Inquiry won't be marked.

Chits:

Chits are essentially a method to tell the EB something when there isn't enough time to verbally do so.

Chits are of two types:

Substantive chits: When there isn't time for you to verbally speak in front of the committee, you can write down your speeches and give them to the EB via a substantive chit.

Procedural chits: These are used to raise a Point of Information when there isn't enough time to do so during a speech.

Moderated Caucus (Mod Caucus):

A discussion on a specific sub-topic within the main agenda. Instead of debating the entire agenda at once, the committee focuses on one smaller issue at a time, such as a particular law, case, or solution. Think of the entire agenda as a book and a moderated caucus topic as one of the chapters of the book

Unmoderated Caucus (Unmod Caucus):

An unmoderated caucus is a dedicated amount of time given for the delegates to discuss among themselves, interact, and form coalitions. This is informal. However, cooperation and the ability to get delegates on your side will be marked as well.

Working Paper:

A working paper is a document containing proposed solutions to the agenda. Given time constraints, the EB encourages you to draft it ahead of time.

They contain sponsors (those who wrote the paper) and signatories (those who support the paper, but don't necessarily agree with every clause).

They have two parts:

● **Preambulatory Clauses:**

- These introduce the background, motives, and reasoning behind the proposal.
- They are not numbered and end with commas
- Use key phrases like Recalling, Noting, Emphasising, Alarmed by, Acknowledging, etc.

● **Operative Clauses:**

- These outline the actions the committee proposes to take.
- They are numbered and end with semicolons (the final one with a period). - Each starts with a strong verb like Calls for, Urges, Recommends, Requests, Decides

Example Working Paper:

All India Political Party Meet (AIPPM) Working paper -

Sponsors: Rahul Gandhi, M.K. Stalin, Mamata Banerjee

Signatories: Farooq Abdullah, Arvind Kejriwal, Sitaram Yechury, Uddhav Thackeray, Nitish Kumar

Topic: “Deliberation on the implementation of a Uniform Civil code”

The All India Political Party Meet,

Acknowledging that Article 44 of the Directive Principles of State Policy specifies the endeavor to secure a Uniform Civil Code, but firmly reiterating that Directive Principles must be read in harmony with Article 25 (Freedom of Conscience and Religion) and Article 26 (Freedom to Manage Religious Affairs),

Deeply concerned by premature attempts to enforce a top-down, blanket uniform legal framework that risks alienating tribal communities, linguistic minorities, and diverse religious groups, thereby threatening the federal fabric and foundational pluralism of Bharat,

Emphasizing the historic findings of the 21st Law Commission of India (2018), which explicitly concluded that a Uniform Civil Code is "neither necessary nor desirable at this stage" and instead advised reforming existing personal laws to eradicate gender discrimination,

1. **Calls upon** the Union Government to prioritize the systematic codification and piecemeal reform of existing personal laws, rather than erasing them entirely, to ensure they align with modern human rights standards;
2. **Urges** the establishment of a statutory, universal Gender-Justice Benchmark applicable across all communities, which strictly outlaws regressive practices including polygamy, arbitrary unilateral divorce, and unequal inheritance rights for women;
3. **Strongly advises** a mandatory, minimum six-month public feedback window conducted in all scheduled regional languages to guarantee democratic consensus and transparency before any civil reform bill is tabled in Parliament.

Right to Reply (RTR):

An RTR is a special rule that is invoked as a response to grave personal insult, allowing a delegate to briefly respond when another delegate's speech insults their/their party's integrity.

To request it you may raise your placard immediately after the offensive speech and ask the EB for permission, or request it via procedural chit. Make sure your demand is valid. The EB will only allow RTR if the insult is genuine and relevant.

If granted, you will typically have a limited amount of speaking time (often 30-60 seconds) to deliver a response.

After this, the delegate who made the offending statement is also given a brief chance to clarify or defend their position (usually the same time limit).

Decorum:

During the committee session, delegates are expected to behave properly. Personal attacks, abusive language, repeated interruptions and serious breaches of decorum may result in warnings, loss of speaking privileges or temporary removal from the committee, at the discretion of the EB.

Press conference:

Press Conference is when Delegates are questioned by the members of the press committee. The goal of a Press Conference is to assess how well the delegates understand their portfolio. Due to that, delegates can be asked absolutely anything relating to their portfolio, regardless of whether it is relevant to the agenda or not, which is why it is advisable that delegates do thorough research on their portfolio.

Moderated Caucus Topics:

1. Evaluating Whether Personal Laws Constitute 'Law' Under Article 13 of the Constitution
2. Evaluating the Role of UCC in Promoting Gender Justice and Equality
3. Delegate's Choice: Delegates may propose any moderated caucus topic related to the agenda. If the motion receives a simple majority, the proposed topic will be discussed by the committee

Note: Due to time constraints, it is highly unlikely that more than one topic will be discussed in committee session. Topic will be determined based on motions raised by delegates. Voting will be conducted, if the motion passes we will proceed with that moderated caucus topic.

Reference Links:

- <https://ijlsi.com/wp-content/uploads/A-Detailed-Study-on-Uniform-Civil-Code-in-regard-with-Personal-Laws-and-its-Reforms.pdf>
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Uniform_Civil_Code
- [https://byjus.com/free-ias-prep/need-for-a-uniform-civil-code-in-a-sec ular-india/](https://byjus.com/free-ias-prep/need-for-a-uniform-civil-code-in-a-sec-ular-india/)

Note: Although the EB has provided these reference links, delegates are supposed to conduct independent research as well. The given information is merely the base of your research, your goal is to build up on it and gather as much information as possible to use during committee hours for debate.

Closing Remarks:

Dear Delegates,

Thank you for taking the time to read these articles. We hope they have helped you better understand the Uniform Civil Code and prepared you for thoughtful and informed debate. Keep in mind that these articles must serve as the basis of your information, and nothing more than the foundation of your research. We request you to conduct extensive research based on the information we have provided, especially through official government websites, judicial websites such as supreme court observer for significant cases, as well as news articles from trusted websites such as The Hindu and The Times Of India. We wish you all the best for your committee sessions and look forward to seeing your ideas and solutions.

Regards,
Chair & Co-Chair
AIPPM